



Security Watch

Skype Targeted

Skype has reported a vulnerability that can be exploited by a Trojan.

The PWS-Pykse Trojan relies on social engineering techniques to trick the victim into executing it; it is usually posted on dodgy sites or forums. The Trojan has also been known to spread through IMs and spam.

It appears as an installer with the Skype logo and named "SkypeDefenderSetup.exe". It infiltrates systems when downloaded.

A fake Skype interface appears with the username and password fields. On entering the details, a message appears: "Your Skype username and password are not recognized. Please check and try again". And while the user keeps trying, the Trojan sends the user's Skype credentials along with other logins and passwords stored in Internet Explorer to the attacker.

The Solution

There's only things you can do—update your virus definitions, and avoid clicking on instant messages with links or read spam (you wouldn't, of course). In addition, just be wary of installing any add-ons to Skype.

though: they argue that any future programmer updating the Linux kernel drivers would need the same level of understanding that the original driver developer received by looking at the manufacturer specifications.

It goes to be seen how far this Linux initiative will go, but this move by Novell is, in general, great news for Linux users—and could certainly mean better device support on various distros.

GAME BLAME

Chinese Universities Ban Personal Computers

Games like *EverQuest* are all the rage in China, and as you might have a clue about, the authorities aren't very happy about it. China being China decided to do what it does best—apply a ban. So later this year, when students join college for the first time, they will not be

allowed to bring their laptops or PCs with them—at the country's top three universities: Zhejiang University, Nanjing University, and Shanghai Jiaotong University. The ban is applicable to all first-year students, irrespective of whether or not they are doing a computer course.

The ban seems rather unenforceable, considering that quite a few students have found ways to install the games on computers in university labs (ostensibly so they can play them at night).

A small poll conducted at Shanghai Jiaotong University revealed that the ban will have no effect whatsoever: after having spent a year playing the games in clandestine fashion, we presume, most of the students polled plan to get their laptops or PCs the next year and continue with their gaming. Some in China believe the only way to be rid of the "menace"—a word the authorities in China seem to like to use—is to approach the root of the problem and educate youngsters on the perils of continuous gaming.

This is not the first time China has proposed a ban

HOT

Mail, unlimited

Yahoo!, Rediff, and Zapakmail have announced unlimited e-mail storage space. Microsoft bumps it up to 5 GB for Live Mail. It's pretty much the same old story of catch-up.



Stuck on old glory NOT

Gmail, the original catalyst of large inboxes, recently upgraded its space to (just!) 4 GB in spite of rumours speculating a 9 GB upgrade. Leaves us not a little surprised—haven't they been following the news?



on gaming—with the hope of creating the perfect working-class society. Back in April, the government hoped to limit the number of hours kids spent on online games by reducing game credits for excessive play.

Essentially, China is trying hard to wean its citizens from dependence on computers and get them to be more responsible in the real world. Of course,

Opinion Poll

What do you think of government-imposed security measures in cyber cafés, such as key loggers, ID checks, and security cameras? (You, too, can participate in this poll—at www.thinkdigit.com)

A They're important for homeland security

B They intrude on our privacy

C ID checks and cameras are good, key loggers are not

D Corrupt government officials may misuse our data

D! I do think the information will be misused. But if implementation of such security measures is stringent, it will scare away unethical users from using cyber cafés.

Naveed Patel
Casanova



I don't like the idea of passing my personal details to a stranger. The owner of the cyber café could forward the logged information to telemarketers for quick money. And I don't think key loggers would help track a terrorist.

Saurabh
Mumbai



It's C for me. I don't think these security measures will help in any way. Cyber cafés will never turn away a customer for not producing an ID. Key loggers may already have been installed by cyber café owners illegally.

Kaushik Patowary
Guwahati



B for me. It's difficult to track down the culprit if a public computer is used. Checking of ID is extremely important, but storing and retrieval of video from CCTV could be difficult.

Yash Maheshwari
Nagpur



C, because I do not think these measures will help in tracking down a criminal. These measures are simply a pain for 'normal' users and personal information could be misused, leading to harassment or even blackmail.

Rajbir Singh
Ludhiana (Punjab)



B is a good option. I think the Government should have a database of verified users. When a user logs in from a public system, he should need to enter his username and password to log on to the Net. I don't like cameras monitoring me but I can live with them.

P C Shyamshankar Chennai



(You, too, can participate in this poll—at www.thinkdigit.com)